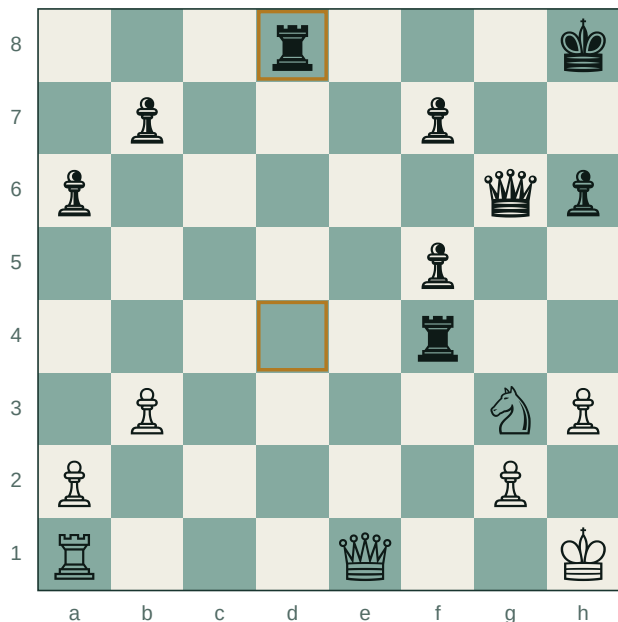


Exposed-king tactics: White, move 37

Exposed-king tactics

White to move



Previous move: 36...Rd8. Gold borders mark its start and finish.

WORKED CONTINUATION - COVER THIS SECTION FIRST

37. Qe5+ Qg7 38. Qxg7+ Kxg7 39. Nh5+ Kg6 40. Nxf4+

37.Qe5+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From e5 it attacks king on h8 and rook on f4. Recorded reply: **37...Qg7**.

38.Qxg7+ Check restricts Black to 1 legal reply here. The move also takes the queen on g7. Recorded reply: **38...Kxg7**.

39.Nh5+ Check restricts Black to 5 legal replies here. From h5 it attacks king on g7 and rook on f4. Recorded reply: **39...Kg6**.

40.Nxf4+ Check restricts Black to 4 legal replies here. The move also takes the rook on f4.

At the end, nominal material is White 12 / Black 10 (P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9). Over this line, White's balance changes by +5. Activity and king safety still affect the evaluation.

CHECKPOINT

Using P=1, N/B=3, R=5, Q=9, how much does White's material balance change over the complete line? **Answer:** +5: the balance goes from -3 to +2. Count promotions and every recapture, not just the first gain.

CARRY THE IDEA INTO YOUR GAMES

A king without pawns is not automatically mated. Count active attackers and examine escapes toward friendly pieces.

WHAT THIS POSITION TEACHES

An exposed king gives the attacker checks and access to nearby squares. Coordinate pieces so the checks drive it into a worse net rather than toward safety.

HOW TO LOOK

Inspect open files, diagonals, and unprotected squares around the king. Calculate checks in an order that preserves the attack.

The defending king is on h8. Geometrically undefended: rook on d8 and rook on f4. Check for tactical protection.